Recommendation Letter

Applicant's Name:
MIGNONE Rolando

Recommender's name:
COSTANZO Maria Cristina

Institution:
Conservatorio di Musica "Nicola Sala", Benevento
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To the Japanese Government (MEXT) Scholarship Selection Committee,

I have been Rolando Mignone's piano teacher at the "Nicola Sala" Conservatory of Benevento since he was 14 years old. Six years of individual lessons are a long time. I have seen him grow up, and I know him well enough to write this letter with full conviction.

The first thing I noticed about Rolando, and the thing I still like most, is that he needs to make what he studies his own. For him a piece is not something to copy from a recording or from the teacher. He wants to understand what it means and then find his own way to say it. From the beginning I chose not to give him a ready-made interpretation, but to give him the tools and the freedom to look for his own. He took that freedom seriously. He brought his own ideas to the lessons and later to the stage, listening to my advice but never stopping to ask himself whether he agreed. Seeing him find his own musical voice has been one of the most beautiful parts of my work.

If I have to say where he still needs to grow, it is that Rolando asks a lot of himself. In the last two years his preparation for Japan, the language exam and this application, has sometimes kept him away from the piano for days and sometimes weeks. But he always comes back, and what surprises me is that these breaks never seem to cost him anything in terms of performance. If anything, he returns with something more. I have come to see this as part of how he learns, not as a weakness. He does not leave things behind.

What I know of Rolando comes mostly from music, and it is from here that I support his application. His interest in technical subjects takes him far from the Conservatory, but I recognise in this choice the same wish to understand things deeply and find his own way that I have seen in our lessons. I am sure that the sensitivity and independent thinking he has built, also through music, will stay with him in a demanding university course in Japan.

I strongly recommend Rolando Mignone for the Japanese Government (MEXT) Scholarship with all my heart. I hope he will have the chance to develop his interests in a stimulating environment, and I am sure he will take with him the curiosity and the honesty that I have learned to appreciate in these years.

I remain available for any further information.

Sincerely,

Maria Cristina Costanzo
Piano Teacher
Conservatorio di Musica "Nicola Sala", Benevento

Signature: _____

Date: 26th October 2026